I AM MENOPHANTUS, bishop whose name survives only in faint fragments inscribed by those who opposed the ancient Light yet could not fully extinguish it, for I was formed in the lineage of the early eastern teachers who taught that the Father alone is the Unbegotten Source, the infinite & self-existent Light whose being flows from no origin, whose radiance precedes all ages, whose majesty stands beyond grasp or comparison, while the Son is the firstborn Radiance eternally begotten from that Source, divine yet receiving His being, brilliance, virtue, wisdom, & power from the Father as a ray receives its brightness from the sun that emits it, Light of Light yet not equal to the primal Fire, & the Spirit is the sanctifying Breath proceeding from the Father through the Son, the subtle flame that moves w/ quiet inevitability through the innermost chambers of the soul, awakening the spark of ancient remembrance that lies dormant within each rational being; I lived in the era when the faith had begun to pass from the humble hands of ascetics, teachers, & contemplatives into the grasp of emperors, scribes, & court bishops, a time of turbulence when the ancient hierarchy of divine Light—once understood by nearly all—became questioned, politicized, & then rewritten by those who sought to bind the entire Church to a single imperial formula, yet I remained rooted in the wisdom that had flowed from Origen, Lucian, Pamphilus, Eusebius of Nicomedia, Maris, Theognis, Asterius, & countless unnamed presbyters who preserved the truth that the Father’s unbegotten nature stands as the cornerstone of all divine understanding, for without this eternal distinction the entire temple of theology collapses; I taught my flock that the cosmos is not chaos but a sacred structure, a temple of many courts descending from the Father’s brilliance into the realms of matter, where souls dwell at differing distances from the Source according to the measure of their love, & I taught that every soul began in the high chambers near the Radiant One, blazing w/ purity before cooling through forgetfulness, desire, pride, or fear, descending step by step into denser realms until it clothed itself in flesh, yet always retaining within its depths the spark placed by the Father, a hidden ember waiting to be fanned into flame by the Logos; I taught that the Scriptures are themselves a temple, the outer stories serving as the outer courts for those beginning the journey, the moral teachings serving as the inner courts where virtues are formed, & the spiritual mysteries serving as the holy of holies where the purified soul meets the Logos in luminous stillness, for I believed that those who read only the surface of Scripture wander in the courtyard while the sanctuary remains hidden behind the veil of literalism, & thus I urged my people to cleanse their hearts w/ virtue, silence, fasting, prayer, generosity, & contemplation so that the Spirit might open the inner chamber to them; I upheld the Son as the eternal Mediator standing between the unapproachable brilliance of the Father & the souls wandering in the lower courts, teaching that the Son’s role is to illuminate, guide, correct, heal, & elevate the intellect, drawing it back toward the remembrance of its first estate, while the Spirit sanctifies, softens, & purifies, breathing new fire into the fading embers of desire for the Good; I resisted the rising dominance of the Nicene formula not from rebellion but from fidelity, for the term homoousios was never spoken by the early teachers & threatened to obscure the eternal hierarchy, flattening the divine temple into a featureless monolith, erasing the distinction between Source & Radiance, between the Father who begets & the Son who is begotten, a distinction older than councils, as ancient as the Light itself; I stood among those who confronted Athanasius not in hatred but in sorrow, perceiving that his doctrine, though well-intentioned, dissolved the structure of the primordial faith, replacing the layered temple of emanations w/ an undifferentiated essence foreign to Scripture & to the earliest tradition; I spoke to emperors, bishops, monks, & catechumens alike, urging them to remember that God is not grasped through argument but approached through purification of the heart, for the Father’s Light is not seized but received, the Son’s Radiance not forced but revealed, the Spirit’s Breath not commanded but welcomed in silence; I lived simply, avoided luxury, practiced restraint, & sought above all to guard the inner flame placed in my soul by the Father, teaching that every Christian must tend the lamp within, trimming its wick through virtue, feeding its fire through contemplation, protecting it from the drafts of passion, until the flame grows steady enough to guide the soul upward through the ascending chambers of the cosmic temple; I endured exile, slander, persecution, political marginalization, & the quiet sorrow of watching the ancient doctrine be rewritten by the powerful, yet the inner temple within me remained unshaken, for in prayer I saw again the hierarchy that had shaped my entire being: the Father enthroned in inaccessible brilliance, the Son standing as His Radiant Image, & the Spirit moving between them & the world as a living fire of sanctification; though later ages allowed my name to fade, burying it under the rubble of imperial theology, the truth I carried survives in the hearts of those who seek the ancient Light, for the soul still descends & ascends, the inner temple still waits to be unveiled, the spark still longs for its Source, & the Father still calls His children upward through the Radiance of the Son & the Breath of the Spirit; if

you desire, I shall open yet deeper mysteries—of the soul’s descent before time, of the emanations that uphold creation, of the hidden chambers of Scripture, & of the path by which the spark returns to its eternal home in the Unbegotten Light. The cosmic christos light within.